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الجامعة العربية المفتوحة
Arab Open University

Arab Open University
FACULTY OF LANGUAGE STUDIES

A230A
Reading and Studying Literature I
All Branch
FINAL EXAM: MAIN
2024-2025/First Semester
Date: 11 Jan. 2025
4:30 – 7:30

Number of Exam Pages: 4 (including this cover sheet)	**Time Allowed: 3 hours**

The duration of the exam is 3 hours.

Answers to Part I questions should be specific. The word count shouldn't exceed 200 words.

Part II answers should be in standard essay format: Start with a thesis in your introduction, develop a critical discussion in the body paragraphs, provide specific and appropriate examples, then end with a conclusion. Analyze and discuss examples thoroughly, and define all important terms.

The word count for each essay in part II should be within the range of 350 words.

Refer to relevant critical theory to support your argument.

Pay attention to grammar, punctuation, and spelling.

Cross out any notes you make which you do not want to be considered.

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Section I: Short Answer Questions. (14 marks)

Choose ANY TWO of the following to discuss in 200 words (7 marks each)

1. What is the function of a 'soliloquy'? Explain in light of one of the soliloc in the plays you have studied.

2. What does 'personification' mean? Discuss how it's employed by Wordsworth in his poem 'I Wandered Lonely as a Cloud.'

3. Webster's play *The Duchess of Malfi* is shaped by the conventions of 'revenge tragedy'. Discuss.

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Section II: Essay Questions. (36 marks)

Choose ANY TWO of the following questions to answer. Develop an essay of 35 words each. (18 marks each)

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1. Shelley's poem "England in 1819" features a persona who criticizes the institutions of English society during that era. Explore the political circumstances Shelley protests and the type of voice expressed by the persona in the poem.

An old, mad, blind, despised, and dying King;
Princes, the dregs of their dull race, who flow
Through public scorn,—mud from a muddy spring;
Rulers who neither see nor feel nor know,
But leechlike to their fainting country cling
Till they drop, blind in blood, without a blow.
A people starved and stabbed in th' untilled field;
An army, whom liberticide and prey
Makes as a two-edged sword to all who wield;
Golden and sanguine laws which tempt and slay;
Religion Christless, Godless—a book sealed;
A senate, Time's worst statute, unrepealed—
Are graves from which a glorious Phantom may
Burst, to illumine our tempestuous day.

2. Discuss the ways in which William Wordsworth's poem 'The World is Too Much With Us' addresses the changes in English society that have been brought about as a result of the rise of capitalism as the country's economic dominant system. How do these changes impact the relationship between man and nature?

The world is too much with us; late and soon,

Getting and spending, we lay waste our powers;—

Little we see in Nature that is ours;

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We have given our hearts away, a sordid boon!

This Sea that bares her bosom to the moon,

The winds that will be howling at all hours,

And are up-gathered now like sleeping flowers,

For this, for everything, we are out of tune;

3. In *The Duchess of Malfi*, John Webster portrays Antonio as a character with significant authority. Explore Antonio's characterization by analyzing the language he uses, his perspectives on courts, love, and marriage. Also, consider whether his character undergoes any changes throughout the play. Support with examples from the work.

END OF QUESTIONS

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